The loss curve said 22 of 22 languages improved. Listening said about 12.

From our own repo: the KittenTTS-indic experiment, October 2026

Loss improved in every language; only about half were intelligible afterwards

22 Indian languages. 4 more were partly intelligible.

22
of 22 languages had lower held-out loss

~12
intelligible by ear and Whisper

6
not usable

Source: KittenTTS-indic write-up, October 2026 (facts.md#kittentts-indic)

Watching the loss curve misses what a listener hears

THE LOSS CURVE

Held-out audio-token loss fell in all 22 languages

Mean drop of 0.81

About 2.3x lower perplexity

A LISTENER

About 12 of 22 languages intelligible

6 of those were already intelligible before fine-tuning

6 languages not usable

How we would gate the next run: listen and transcribe first

Illustrative: the check we would add

01 **Short pilot**

Train briefly, then generate fixed test sentences per language.

02 **Listen and transcribe**

A person rates each language, and Whisper checks the audio against the input text.

03 **Gate**

Only languages that pass get the long GPU run.

What to record for each language before the long run

Ear	intelligible, partial or not usable
ASR	does the transcript match the input text?
Loss	still tracked, never trusted on its own

Source: Illustrative

What do you check before you trust a falling loss curve?

Scoping is short, fixed and ends in a written plan.

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